STATEMENT–CONCLUSION

Inference, Course of Action and Rule Application

OAVS TGT | Reasoning (Verbal) | Topic 9 of the syllabus list

Syllabus line (Reasoning, 30 Marks): “The Verbal Reasoning topics like Series, Ranks, Direction, Arrangement, Coding, Decoding, Analogy and Classification/Odd Pair, Syllogism and **Statement Conclusion**.” This is the last topic in the verbal list.

Built from: OAVS TGT English 2019, English 2022, Mathematics 2024, Science 2024 and Social Studies 2023 (17 May 2023, Shift 2). All 5 statement–conclusion questions found in these papers are solved here. Science 2024 had none.

What is inside

Ch.	Title	What you get
1	PYQ Analysis	Counts, patterns, priority, index of all 5 PYQs
2	Foundation	The three question types and the rules for each
3	Inference from a Statement	‘Which conclusions follow’ (1 PYQ)
4	Course of Action	‘Should’ conclusions: practical, relevant, not extreme (2 PYQs)
5	Rule Application	Criteria and eligibility questions (2 PYQs)
6	Assumption and Argument (expected)	Two further types likely in other papers
7	Shortcuts, Traps and Scope	Speed methods and common mistakes
8	Practice Set	16 original questions with answer key
9	Quick Revision	One-page cheat sheet

SCOPE: Syllogisms (All / No / Some) are a different type and were covered in the previous PDF. Here the statements are about **situations, rules or opinions**, not about groups of things.

CHAPTER 1

PYQ Analysis

Statement–Conclusion: about 1 question per paper

Paper	Q. numbers	Count	What was asked
English 2019	45	1	Eligibility criteria with two exceptions; one candidate
English 2022	33, 50	2	Course of action; criteria with two conclusions
Mathematics 2024	97	1	Courses of action for a stated plan
Science 2024	none	0	—
Social Studies 2023	25	1	Inference from a health statement
Total		**5**	**Found in four of the five papers**

Pattern	PYQs	Priority
Rule / criteria application (check each rule against each case)	2	★★★ Must
Course of action (‘should’ conclusions)	2	★★★ Must
Inference from a statement (what must be true)	1	★★★ Must
Expected, not yet asked: assumption, argument (strong / weak), cause and effect	0	★★ Expected

PYQ INSIGHT: Four of five PYQs reward the same two habits: use only what the statement says, and reject extreme conclusions. Eng 2022 Q33 (‘sell all government organisations’) and Maths 2024 Q97 (‘quit the idea of business’) are both rejected because they overreach or contradict the aim.

PYQ INSIGHT: Two PYQs are rule-application questions (Eng 2019 Q45, Eng 2022 Q50). They are mechanical: list the criteria, test the candidate against each, and do not assume anything the question does not give.

Index of the 5 PYQs

Paper / Q	Type	Question in short	Answer	See
Eng 2019 Q45	Rule application	Recruitment criteria; Sumitra (61% / 63%, 4.5 years, 58.5%)	To be selected	5.1
Eng 2022 Q33	Course of action	Private employees more professional than government ones	Only II	4.1
Eng 2022 Q50	Rule application	Exam criteria: reserved 52%; Ph.D. enrolled 54%	Only I	5.2
Maths 2024 Q97	Course of action	Saxena wants to start a footwear business	(i) and (ii)	4.2
SST 2023 Q25	Inference	Fast food, inactivity and obesity	Both follow	3.1

CHAPTER 2

Foundation

Three question types and how to handle each

Type	Statement is…	You decide…	Key test
Inference (conclusion)	A fact or claim	Which conclusions **must be true** from the statement	Is it supported by the statement itself? Is it extreme?
Course of action	A problem or plan	Which actions **should be taken**	Is it relevant, practical and not extreme?
Rule application	A set of criteria	Which conclusions follow for a given candidate	Does the candidate meet every criterion?
Assumption (expected)	A claim or advice	What must be taken for granted	Is it necessary for the statement to make sense?
Argument (expected)	A ‘should…?’ question	Which arguments are strong	Is it relevant, specific and important?

General rules (all types)

- **Take the statement as true**, even if you disagree. Never use outside facts.
- **Stay inside the statement:** a conclusion cannot bring in new information.
- **Be wary of extreme words** (all, only, never, always, must, completely) unless the statement uses them.
- **Opinions are not conclusions:** a conclusion must be supported, not just plausible.
- **Weaker words are safer:** ‘can’, ‘may’, ‘likely’ follow more easily than ‘will’ and ‘certainly’.

Word test for conclusions

Conclusion uses…	Usually…	Example
‘All’, ‘never’, ‘only’, ‘will certainly’	does not follow	‘All government organisations should be sold’
‘Many’, ‘some’, ‘can’, ‘may’	may follow if supported	‘Diet and lifestyle contribute to obesity’
A restatement of the statement	follows	‘Not active enough → prone to obesity’
A new fact or a prediction	does not follow	‘Customers will switch to paper bags’

CHAPTER 3

Inference from a Statement

Which conclusions logically follow: 1 PYQ

3.1 SST 2023 Q25

PYQ SST 2023 Q25 Both conclusions restate the statement

Q. Statement: Consuming large amounts of processed or fast foods, which are high in fat and sugar, can cause obesity. Lack of physical activity also contributes to increase in obesity. Conclusions: I. If a person is not active enough and does not use the energy provided by the food that he/she eats, he/she can be prone to obesity. II. Diet and lifestyle factors contribute to development of obesity and overweight.

Step 1. The statement gives two causes: fast food (a diet factor) and lack of physical activity (a lifestyle factor).
Step 2. I: not being active enough and not using the energy from food is the second sentence in other words. It uses 'can be prone', a weak word. **Follows.**
Step 3. II: diet (fast food) and lifestyle (inactivity) both contribute to obesity. **Follows.**
Answer: Both conclusions follow (Option 4)

SHORTCUT: Method: underline every claim in the statement; then check whether the conclusion says the same thing in other words. Here both conclusions are summaries, so both follow.

Conclusion	Supported by	Strength word	Verdict
I	Sentence 2 (lack of physical activity contributes)	'can be prone' (weak)	Follows
II	Sentences 1 and 2 together	'contribute'	Follows

CHAPTER 4

Course of Action

What should be done: 2 PYQs

Accept an action if it is…	Reject an action if it is…
Relevant to the problem or plan stated	Unrelated or only loosely related
Practical and possible for the authority	Extreme (close everything, sell everything, ban for ever)
A **step** that moves towards the aim	Contradicts the stated aim ('quit the idea')
Positive and constructive	Punitive, vague or passive ('do nothing')

4.1 Eng 2022 Q33

PYQ Eng 2022 Q33 Constructive vs extreme

Q. Statement: The employees of private organisations have more professionalism than the employees of government organisations. Conclusions: I. The government should sell all the government organisations to convert them into private organisations. II. The responsible authorities should take proper steps to improve professionalism in government employees.

Step 1. I: 'sell all' is extreme. The statement says nothing about selling organisations. **Does not follow.**
Step 2. II: a proper step to improve professionalism responds directly to the gap stated. It is practical and constructive. **Follows.**
Answer: Only conclusion II follows (Option A)

4.2 Maths 2024 Q97

PYQ Maths 2024 Q97 Actions that serve the stated plan

Q. Statement: Saxena wants to quit his job at a BPO and start his own business of footwear. Courses of action: (i) Saxena must plan beforehand the details of starting a footwear business. (ii) Saxena must arrange money to start his own business. (iii) Saxena must quit the idea of business and pursue another dream.

Step 1. (i) Planning the details is a necessary and practical step towards the stated aim. **Follows.**
Step 2. (ii) Money is required to start a business: a direct step. **Follows.**
Step 3. (iii) Giving up the idea contradicts what Saxena wants. **Does not follow.**
Answer: Both actions (i) and (ii) follow (Option A)

TRAP: A course of action that **cancels the plan** is not a solution to the plan. In Q97 the correct actions are the ones that help Saxena do what he wants, not stop him.

CHAPTER 5

Rule Application

Criteria and eligibility: 2 PYQs

Step	Do this
1	List every criterion and every exception clause (A), (B) with the exact numbers.
2	Test the candidate against **each** criterion in order; write ✓ or ✗.
3	If all pass, the answer is ‘selected / can apply’. If one fails, check whether an **exception** exactly matches that single failure.
4	If information for a criterion is missing, the answer is ‘data inadequate’ (do not assume).

5.1 Eng 2019 Q45: recruitment criteria

Criteria: (i) a graduate in commerce with at least 60% marks; (ii) age at least 24 and not more than 40 as on 1-4-2018; (iii) post-qualification work experience of at least 2 years; (iv) at least 55% marks in the selection process. Exceptions: (A) fails (i) but has a post-graduation degree in finance with at least 60% → referred to the Finance Manager; (B) fails (iii) only but has 75% in selection → may be referred to the Trainee Accountant. **Sumitra** is within the age limit. She did graduation and post-graduation in commerce with 61% and 63%. She has 4.5 years’ experience as a senior accountant and secured 58.5% in the selection process.

Criterion	Requirement	Sumitra	Check
(i) Graduation	Commerce graduate, at least 60%	Commerce, 61%	✓
(ii) Age	24 to 40 years on 1-4-2018	‘According to the advertisement’	✓
(iii) Experience	At least 2 years post-qualification	4.5 years	✓
(iv) Selection	At least 55%	58.5%	✓

RESULT: Answer: the candidate is to be selected (Option A). She passes all four criteria, so neither exception clause is needed. The PG marks (63%) are extra information. The question says *‘you are not to assume anything other than the information provided’*: age is given as ‘according to the advertisement’, so it passes.

5.2 Eng 2022 Q50: exam criteria

PYQ Eng 2022 Q50 Marks criterion with relaxation

Q. Statements: Criteria to apply for an examination: applicants must have a master's degree or equivalent from a recognised institution. Candidates should have scored 55% marks, and reserved category candidates 50%. A 5% relaxation is given to Ph.D. degree holders in aggregate marks. Conclusions: I. Candidate X, who belongs to the reserved category and has scored 52% marks, can apply. II. Candidate Y, who has enrolled in the Ph.D. programme and scored 54% marks, can apply.

Step 1. I: reserved category needs 50%; X has 52%, which is above 50%. **Follows.**
Step 2. II: the relaxation is for Ph.D. **degree holders**. Y has only **enrolled** in the programme, so there is no relaxation; she needs 55%, and 54% is below it. **Does not follow.**
Answer: Only conclusion I follows (Option B)

TRAP: 'Enrolled in a Ph.D.' is not the same as 'Ph.D. degree holder'. One word often decides a rule-application question. (The conclusions do not mention the master's degree; the key judges them on the marks criteria that the conclusions test.)

CHAPTER 6

Assumption and Argument (expected)

Two types not yet asked in these five papers; likely elsewhere

6.1 Assumption

An assumption is something taken for granted that must be true for the statement to make sense. Test: **if the assumption were false, would the statement still make sense?** If not, the assumption holds.

Statement	Assumption	Verdict
Use the metro to reach the office on time.	I. The metro runs on schedule.	Holds (otherwise the advice is pointless)
	II. The office is far from home.	Does not hold (not necessary)

6.2 Argument (strong or weak)

Strong argument	Weak argument
Relevant to the question, specific and important	Vague, personal, emotional, or based on a mere example
Gives a clear benefit or harm	Says 'because everyone does', or compares with something unrelated

Statement	Argument	Verdict
Should plastic be banned?	I. Yes, it harms the environment and is hard to dispose of.	Strong
	II. No, plastic is used everywhere.	Weak (use is not a reason)

CHAPTER 7

Shortcuts, Traps and Scope

Speed methods and common mistakes

- **Underline the claim** in the statement and compare it with each conclusion; if it says the same thing, it follows.
- **Cross out extreme conclusions** (all, never, only, sell all, ban for ever).
- **Actions:** check 'relevant, practical, not extreme' in 3 seconds each.
- **Rules:** tick each criterion; look for the word that breaks a rule ('enrolled' vs 'degree holder'); missing facts mean 'data inadequate'.

Trap	How to avoid it
Using personal knowledge	Use only what the statement or rules say.
Choosing a conclusion because it sounds sensible	It must be supported, not just reasonable.
Accepting an action that cancels the plan	‘Quit the idea’ fails Maths 2024 Q97.
Over-reading a rule	‘Relaxation for Ph.D. holders’ does not cover Ph.D. students.
Using an exception when all criteria are already met	Sumitra passes everything; no referral applies.

Scope check

Type	Where it belongs
Maths 2024 Q81, Q87, Q88; Science 2024 Q78, Q80, Q100; Eng 2019 Q35, Q38; SST 2023 Q24	‘All / No / Some’ group statements: Syllogism PDF (done)
Number and letter puzzles, equation signs (Eng 2022 Q57; Science 2024 Q81, Q94)	Not in the listed syllabus

CHAPTER 8

Practice Set

16 original questions; answers on the next page

Q	Statement / rules	Conclusions / question
1	Statement: All the students who scored above 90% in the unit test received a book prize.	Conclusions: I. Ravi, who scored 95%, received a book prize. II. All students who received a book prize scored above 90%.
2	Statement: Regular exercise reduces the risk of heart disease.	Conclusions: I. People who do not exercise will certainly get heart disease. II. Exercise can help lower the chance of heart disease.
3	Statement: The company has declared a bonus for employees who completed five years of service.	Conclusions: I. Employees with six years of service will get the bonus. II. All employees will get the bonus.
4	Statement: Many farmers in the region have shifted to drip irrigation after the water level in wells dropped.	Conclusions: I. The water level in wells has dropped. II. All farmers in the region use drip irrigation.
5	Statement: A large number of students have fallen ill after eating the mid-day meal.	Courses of action: I. The school should stop serving the meal until the cause is found. II. The students who ate the meal should be given medical aid.
6	Statement: The road in front of the school is full of potholes and several children have been injured.	Courses of action: I. The authorities should repair the road immediately. II. The school should be closed permanently.
7	Statement: The government plans to build a new airport near the city.	Courses of action: I. Land should be acquired and the affected families should be compensated. II. The old airport should be demolished at once.
8	Statement: Many people in the colony are suffering from malaria.	Courses of action: I. The authorities should spray anti-mosquito medicine. II. All residents should be shifted out of the colony.
9	Rules for a sports academy: (i) age 12 to 16 years; (ii) at least 60% marks in the last class; (iii) pass the fitness test. Exception: a candidate who fails only (ii) but has a state-level medal may be sent to the principal.	Arjun is 14 years old, scored 72% and passed the fitness test. What follows?
10	(Same rules as Q9.)	Meera is 13, scored 55%, passed the fitness test and has a state-level medal. What follows?
11	(Same rules as Q9.)	Rohan is 17, scored 80% and passed the fitness test. What follows?
12	(Same rules as Q9.)	Zoya is 15 years old and scored 65% marks. What follows?
13	Statement: Use the metro to reach the office on time.	Assumptions: I. The metro runs on schedule. II. The office is very far from home.
14	Statement: ‘Please take an umbrella; it may rain.’	Assumptions: I. An umbrella protects from rain. II. It will certainly rain today.
15	Statement: Should schools provide free textbooks to all students?	Arguments: I. Yes, it reduces the financial burden on poor families. II. No, because students will not value free books.
16	Statement: Should plastic be banned?	Arguments: I. Yes, plastic harms the environment and is hard to dispose of. II. No, plastic is used everywhere.

Answer key with reason

Q	Answer	Reason
1	Only I	Ravi scored above 90%, so he got a prize. II reverses the statement (others may have got a prize for other reasons).
2	Only II	‘Reduces the risk’ supports ‘can help lower the chance’. ‘Certainly’ in I is extreme.
3	Only I	Six years includes five years completed. II says ‘all employees’: extreme.
4	Only I	‘After the water level dropped’ states it. ‘Many’ does not mean ‘all’.
5	Both	Stop the meal until the cause is known; give medical aid: relevant, practical, constructive.
6	Only I	Repairing the road addresses the cause. Closing the school permanently is extreme.
7	Only I	Land acquisition and compensation are practical steps for the plan. Demolishing the old airport is unrelated and extreme.
8	Only I	Spraying addresses mosquitoes. Moving all residents is impractical and extreme.
9	Selected	Age 14 ✓, 72% ✓, fitness ✓.
10	Sent to the principal	Fails only (ii) (55% < 60%) and has the state medal: the exception applies.
11	Not selected	Age 17 is above 16; no exception covers an age failure.
12	Data inadequate	The fitness test result is not given; do not assume.
13	Only I	The advice makes sense only if the metro is on schedule. Distance is not needed.
14	Only I	The advice assumes an umbrella protects from rain. ‘Certainly’ in II contradicts ‘may rain’.
15	Only I strong	I is relevant and specific. II is a speculation about students’ attitude.
16	Only I strong	I gives a clear harm. II says it is used everywhere, which is not a reason against a ban.

CHAPTER 9

Quick Revision

One page for the last day

Type	Rule	PYQ check
Inference	Supported by the statement; no extreme words; no new facts	SST 2023 Q25: both follow
Course of action	Relevant, practical, constructive; not extreme; does not cancel the aim	Eng 2022 Q33: only II; Maths 2024 Q97: (i) and (ii)
Rule application	Tick each criterion; exceptions only if they match exactly; missing info = data inadequate	Eng 2019 Q45: selected; Eng 2022 Q50: only I
Assumption (expected)	Necessary for the statement to make sense	'Use the metro' assumes the metro is on time
Argument (expected)	Strong = relevant, specific, important	Plastic harms the environment: strong

ROUTINE: Exam-day routine: underline the claim, cross out extreme words, check the aim for actions, tick the rules one by one. 40 seconds per question.